HOORVIA - PIGMENT LOAD CHART: PRINTABLE WATERCOLOR GRADE & BRAND GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Crafting & DIY · Sheet #1

Paint / Grade	Pigment Load	Lightfastness	Mixing & Finish
Artist-grade watercolor	~30-40% pigment	ASTM I-II (excellent)	Rich, clean mixes; single pigments
Student-grade watercolor	Below 15-20% pigment	Often unrated / ASTM III	Flatter color, more filler
Professional (Daniel Smith)	Highest, single-pigment	ASTM I	Maximum strength, archival
Winsor & Newton Professional	High	ASTM I-II	Pure pigments, clean glazing
Winsor & Newton Cotman	Lower, fillers added	Variable	Good practice paint, less vibrant
Sennelier Artist	~2x student-grade pigment	ASTM I-II	Honey-based, luminous washes
Schmincke Horadam	Very high	ASTM I	Intense color, fine grind
Holbein Artists'	High, single-pigment	ASTM I-II	Opaque-leaning, strong tinting
M. Graham	High, honey binder	ASTM I-II	Rewets easily, vivid color
"Hue" colors (student)	Low - mixed substitutes	Often unrated	Cheaper imitation of pricey pigments
Gouache (opaque watercolor)	High pigment + chalk	ASTM I-II	Matte, opaque finish
Acrylic paint	High pigment in resin	ASTM I-II	Fast-drying, permanent film

PRO TIP: Check the label: Single-pigment colors list one pigment code - mixes labeled "hue" are substitutes, not the real pigment.